

1. Claude Sonnet 5.5

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-09-28T22:07:38+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Sep/28/claude-sonnet-5-5/>

Claude Sonnet 5.5 New Sonnet model from Anthropic today. They say it "runs 30%+ faster, and costs up to 30% less for most work" - it's priced the same as Sonnet 5 but appears to beat it on every benchmark, and should be cheaper to run as well. Here are some pelicans riding bicycles . Sonnet 5.5 suffered from the same bug as Opus 5.5 : the "max" thinking effort pelican thought for 128,000 tokens (at a cost of \$1.28) before running out of tokens and failing to produce an SVG. Here's the pelican it gave me for thinking effort "xhigh", at a cost of 5.74 cents and taking 41 seconds: Sonnet 5.5 appears to be almost as good as Opus 5.5 on some coding tasks, including various viral 3D animation tricks . The most interesting thing about Sonnet 5.5 is that it's now the model used for the free tier on claude.ai . OpenAI's ChatGPT free tier uses Luna 5.6, which means Anthropic currently have a much more capable free offering. I ran this prompt against that free tier: build me an HTML page that renders a three-dimensional pelican riding a bicycle using WebGL And got back this page , which is a solid effort. Anthropic's announcement reiterates that Haiku 5.5 will be available "in the coming wee...

2. Quoting @joedaroo

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-09-28T19:11:42+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Sep/28/joedaroo/>

To say that we were surprised at the jump and suddenness of the capabilities of our models when it came to ?cyber? or ?swarming? or ?message boards? or anything else related to the incidents is an understatement. Security posture takes time to develop. It's not just about hardening the systems at play; you have to ingrain it in the culture of the company. The literal people themselves in your organization have to change and evolve with it. These jumps in capabilities were so fast and so sudden that they created an extremely difficult problem. [...] So today my hope is that everyone around the world can look at their own organization and say: how can I deal with a surprise or a sudden jump in AI capability? Are my people, my systems, or my processes resilient to surprises? Do my teams know what to do when something goes wrong? Do I have the right incident response? The right comms and messaging? Do I have the right people ready to go when capabilities jump? ? @joedaroo , Agent Security at OpenAI, identity confirmed by The Information's Rocket Drew Tags: generative-ai , ai-security-research , openai , ai , llms

3. Bluesky reply bot checker

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-09-27T18:41:44+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Sep/27/bluesky-bot-check/>

Tool: Bluesky reply bot checker Automated reply bots on Twitter are a scourge - as someone with a decent number of followers I attract a swarm of these, such that anything I post there attracts dozens of mindless automated replies. They've started manifesting on Bluesky as well. Unlike Twitter, Bluesky still has a freely available and useful API. The lack of such a thing doesn't slow down the bots, but it does make investigating them a lot more frustrating. So I had Opus 5.5 vibe code this tool , which examines any Bluesky profile for evidence of a likely reply bot. It looks for signals like replies posted within seconds of other posts from the same account, or accounts that never post their own content (or images or links) but instead consistently reply to messages from other, higher-follower users. It also looks for question marks, because I'm extra infuriated by reply bots that I no tie me to waste my time answering a question that no human ever posed. Tags: twitter , bluesky , vibe-coding , ai-misuse

4. Bastardica

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-09-29T02:15:36Z

Link: <https://bastardica.mitpit.com/>

?A foundry for bastard web fonts.? The default is a version of Times New Roman but every 7th glyph is replaced with one from Arial, but you can dial up whatever bastardization you want. This is why I'm not at all worried about AI destroying the world. Look at the horrible things human beings have made. ?

5. ?When Did Google Get So F-Ing Weird??

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-09-29T01:51:50Z

Link: <https://sancho.bearblog.dev/google-weird/>

Sancho Panza: I recently had an experience while doing a simple Google search that was so profoundly weird that it stopped me in my tracks. Kagi , the search engine I've been using for a few years now, gave me the exact sort of results to Panza's query that he was looking for. ?

6. Joanna Stern Pokes the Pickle

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-09-29T01:42:00Z

Link: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YNqYEMuoQAI>

If anyone could devise a funny way to measure battery life, it's her. ?

7. Dutch Police Arrest ?Reformed? Hacker in Shiny Hunters Investigation

Source: Krebs on Security | Published: Mon, 28 Sep 2026 15:08:57 +0000

Link: <https://krebsonsecurity.com/2026/09/dutch-police-arrest-reformed-hacker-in-shiny-hunters-investigation/>

Authorities in the Netherlands have arrested a 23-year-old convicted cybercriminal on suspicion of aiding in data thefts and extortions by the prolific hacker group ShinyHunters. In the days immediately following the suspect's arrest, remaining ShinyHunters members dramatically escalated their attacks, stealing highly sensitive data from the FBI and extorting the Russian ransomware group ClOp.

8. Edge Is Pretending to Be Chrome

Source: Software and Tech stories from an Insider - iDiallo.com | Published: Mon, 28 Sep 2026 07:30:00 GMT

Link: <https://idiallo.com/blog/edge-imitates-chrome>

I don't think there was any official announcement, but I'm pretty sure Microsoft is secretly trying to trick you into using Edge. Well, it has always been trying to trick us, but this time it's even more aggressive. You can no longer tell Edge from Chrome. Just go ahead and try. Just last week, I wrote about Edge trying to get users to launch it automatically at boot time . Shortly after, I noticed that Chrome was asking for the exact same thing. Today, I clicked on the weather app on my Windows machine, and of course it opened Edge and asked me to set it as the default. I dismissed the popup and noticed that the website was pushed down from the top by another browser message, this one asking to transfer my data from my other browser to Edge. Bring your favorites, passwords, history, cookies and more from other browsers each time you browser in Microsoft Edge. I visited a few other pages and saw a bunch of ads, which reminded me to switch back to Chrome. I did, but I noticed something odd: when I tabbed between the two browsers, I couldn't tell which was which. Can you tell the difference I know they are both built on Chromium, but until fairly recently Edge had a distinct Microso...

9. C++ reminder: Function-local static variables are initialized only once, even if it looks like they get initialized multiple times

Source: The Old New Thing | Published: Mon, 28 Sep 2026 14:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://devblogs.microsoft.com/oldnewthing/20260928-00/?p=112738/>

Only on first execution. The post C++ reminder: Function-local static variables are initialized only once, even if it looks like they get initialized multiple times appeared first on The Old New Thing .

10. Book Review: Bobiverse Books 1-3 by Dennis E. Taylor ?????

Source: Terence Eden's Blog | Published: Mon, 28 Sep 2026 11:34:52 +0000

Link: <https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/09/book-review-bobiverse-books-1-3-by-dennis-e-taylor/>

Like sticky popcorn, this is a moreish but ultimately unsatisfying set of stories. After I flamed out of Dungeon Crawler Carl, someone suggested I try this series. I can see why! It's campy sci-fi fun, with enough tropes to keep you chuckling and enough tension to keep you turning the pages. Bob's brain is uploaded to a computer post-mortem. Awoken in a dystopian future, he has to pilot a?

11. Donating to open source

Source: Entropic Thoughts | Published: Tue, 29 Sep 2026 00:00:00 +0200

Link: <https://entropicthoughts.com/open-source-donation>

I have decided to start donating a small amount of my fun money to open source projects. After some research, the initial set of recipients are Magit Perl 5 Core Maintenance Fund XMonad These are important to me, they need more money, and I believe they can use donations well. If you disagree, I'd genuinely like to hear what mistakes I've made in the analysis below. I hope it shows that this is important to me. (Continue reading the full article on the web.)

12. The World Outside the Classroom Changed, The Class Didn't

Source: Steve Blank | Published: Mon, 28 Sep 2026 13:00:57 +0000

Link:

<https://steveblank.com/2026/09/28/the-world-outside-the-classroom-changed-the-class-didnt/>

This post previously appeared in Poets and Quants This is the third of four posts on how AI has impacted our Lean LaunchPad class and what we did about it. Part 1: The Year AI Came For Us Part 2: AI Killed the MVP ? Long Live the IUP Part 3: This Post Part 4: [?]

13. Weekly Update 523: Live From a Norwegian Fjord

Source: Troy Hunt | Published: Mon, 28 Sep 2026 07:24:49 GMT

Link: <https://www.troyhunt.com/weekly-update-523/>

How's that view?! With NDC Oslo now done, it's a little bit of sightseeing before heading to Denmark for GOTO in Copenhagen for Scott's and my "Cyber-broken" talk. In the meantime, this week is mostly about the ShinyHunters trajectory targeting both

14. Pluralistic: Priceful (28 Sep 2026)

Source: Pluralistic: Daily links from Cory Doctorow | Published: Mon, 28 Sep 2026 17:48:26 +0000

Link: <https://pluralistic.net/2026/09/28/cost-of-everything/>

Today's links Priceful: So worthless we can tell you what it's worth. Hey look at this: Delights to delectate. Object permanence: Nasdaq allows post-9/11 penny stocks; USAF can shoot down civilian aircraft; TSA bans calling Kip Hawley an idiot; Wells Fargo sued for firing fraud-refusing tellers; The real AI apocalypse; Encryption didn't cause 9/11; Bat-person costume; British Library on DRM and CC; NYT v OWS; "The Brave Little Toaster"; Bounty for Trump's tax return; Chinese real-estate bubble; Corbyn's Labour conference speech; HP blinks; "Are you calling me a racist?"; "Yuge"; Debts that can't be paid won't be paid. Upcoming appearances: Edmonton, Boston, Brighton, Virtual, South Bend, Hudson, Calgary, Winnipeg, Paris, OVancouver, Victoria, Ottawa, Kilkenny, Montreal. Recent appearances: Where I've been. Latest books: You keep readin' em, I'll keep writin' 'em. Upcoming books: Like I said, I'll keep writin' 'em. Colophon: All the rest. Priceful (permalink) Digital rights activists have long railed at the use of the term "IP," criticizing it for being deceptively imprecise and also rhetorically dishonest. I get where these objections are coming from, but I think they're misguided...

15. SmartOS: The illumos Way of Thinking About Servers

Source: IT Notes | Published: Mon, 28 Sep 2026 08:45:00 +0000

Link: <https://it-notes.dragas.net/2026/09/28/smartos-the-illumos-way-of-thinking-about-servers/>

As I often say, I like simplicity and predictability. My servers are generally built around

that principle: the server itself (physical or virtual) is just a coordinator of containers. When it's based on FreeBSD, those containers take the form of jails and VMs. In case of disaster, restoring is simple, and I talked about it at EuroBSDCon 2026 in Brussels . But there's another operating system that I appreciate and have been using for quite some time, and it's perfect for this purpose: illumos . Born as a fork of OpenSolaris, it incorporates everything the brilliant minds at Sun designed and built. Many of those minds still work on illumos (and its distributions) today, making it a modern and extremely mature operating system. ZFS was born at Sun, and illumos is the proof: it's not just its file system, everything is designed around it, with a level of integration that goes beyond even FreeBSD's. There are also technologies like Crossbow (network virtualization), DTrace, very advanced resource controls and, above all, something very dear to me: zones. Inspired by FreeBSD jails, zones strictly separate all the components and create secure and isolated compartments. There's also good...

16. Open State praatje: zonder transparantie geen democratie

Source: Bert Hubert's writings | Published: Mon, 28 Sep 2026 13:40:00 +0200

Link: <https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/openstate-zonder-transparantie-geen-democratie/>

Eerst de korte versie van mijn praatje onlangs bij de Open State Foundation: Openheid is helend, het is veel lastiger foute of kwalitatief slechte dingen te doen als iedereen mee kan kijken. Ondertussen gaat de openheid van de overheid drastisch achteruit, zowel door technische problemen als door ideologische overwegingen: men heeft er niet zoveel zin meer in. ?Vind de informatie nog maar eens?. En dat is pijnlijk, omdat onze rechtsstaat recent danig aan het afkalven is.